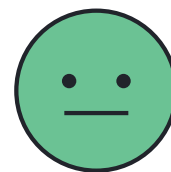
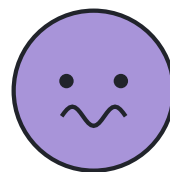
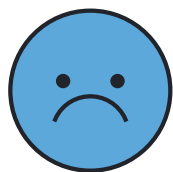




CALM & CONFIDENT SEL SERIES



# Feelings Detective

A Social-Emotional Learning Activity Book - Investigate, Name &  
Solve Big Feelings

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

**Ages 5-17 - Printable**

**Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners**

Reproducible for one home or classroom



# How to Use This Book

Welcome! This book helps kids and teens understand big feelings and learn calm, kind ways to handle them. Feelings are not good or bad - they are messengers. This book builds the skills to listen to them and choose what to do next.

Every page is printable and reproducible for your home or classroom. Go at the reader's pace, and celebrate effort more than 'right answers.'

## For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Do the activities alongside the child when you can - your calm helps them feel safe.
- ☐ Name feelings out loud together; naming a feeling helps shrink it.
- ☐ Never punish a feeling. Coach the choice that comes after it.
- ☐ Revisit favorite pages often - skills grow with practice, not one-time reading.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



# Grows With the Reader (Ages 5-17)

This book is built for a wide range of ages. Younger children can color, trace, and point to feelings faces. Older kids and teens can use the same pages for journaling, deeper reflection, and building real coping plans.

## Younger (about 5-9)

- ☐ Color the feelings faces and calm-down pictures.
- ☐ Trace the calming words and short affirmations.
- ☐ Do the breathing shapes with a grown-up.

## Older kids & teens (about 10-17)

- ☐ Write in the journal and reflection spaces.
- ☐ Work through the 'What would you do?' scenarios.
- ☐ Build and personalize your own coping toolkit and calm-down plan.

# What's Inside



- 1 Becoming a Feelings Detective
- 2 Clues in the Body
- 3 Reading Others' Feelings
- 4 Calm-Down Tools
- 5 Solving Feeling Mysteries
- 6 Calm & Reflect
- 7 My Plan
- 8 Gratitude



## **Part 1: Becoming a Feelings Detective**

Every feeling leaves clues.



# Your Detective Badge

Detectives look for clues to solve mysteries. YOU can be a Feelings Detective! Your job is to notice the clues that tell you what you (and others) are feeling - then figure out what would help.



## Detective's oath

I promise to look for clues, name feelings kindly, and use what I learn to help myself and others feel calmer and safer.

# Face Clues to Investigate



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



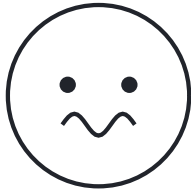
Happy



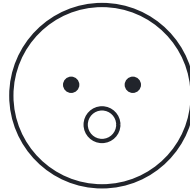
Sad



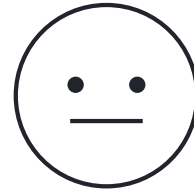
Angry



Worried



Surprised

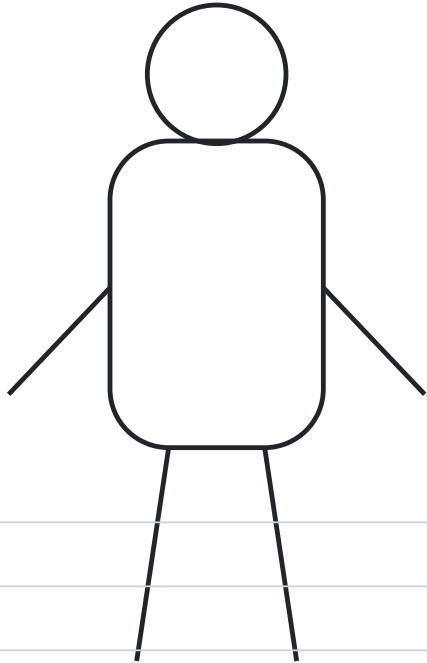


Calm



## Where Do I Feel It?

Big feelings live in our bodies too. Anger might feel hot in your chest. Worry might feel like butterflies in your tummy. Color or mark where you feel your feelings.



### Draw or color:

-  Hot / angry feelings
-  Fluttery / worried feelings
-  Heavy / sad feelings
-  Calm / good feelings

Today my body feels...



# Body Clue Chart

Feelings leave clues in the body. Match the clue to the feeling it often means.

- ☐ Hot face, clenched fists -> often ANGER
- ☐ Butterflies, fast heart -> often WORRY
- ☐ Heavy body, tears -> often SADNESS
- ☐ Big smile, bouncy body -> often JOY
- ☐ Slow breathing, loose shoulders -> often CALM

**My own body clues are...**

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## Part 2: Reading Others' Feelings

Great detectives notice other people too.

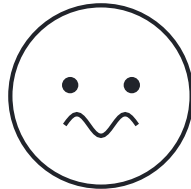
# What Might They Feel?



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



left out



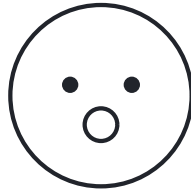
nervous



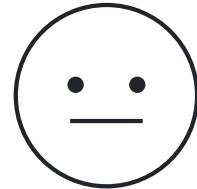
frustrated



proud



shocked



content



# Match the Clue to the Feeling

Draw a line from each clue to the feeling it might mean.

● Crossed arms, frown

excited ●

● Wide eyes, gasp

sad ●

● Slumped shoulders

surprised ●

● Jumping, cheering

angry ●



## Part 2: My Calm-Down Tools

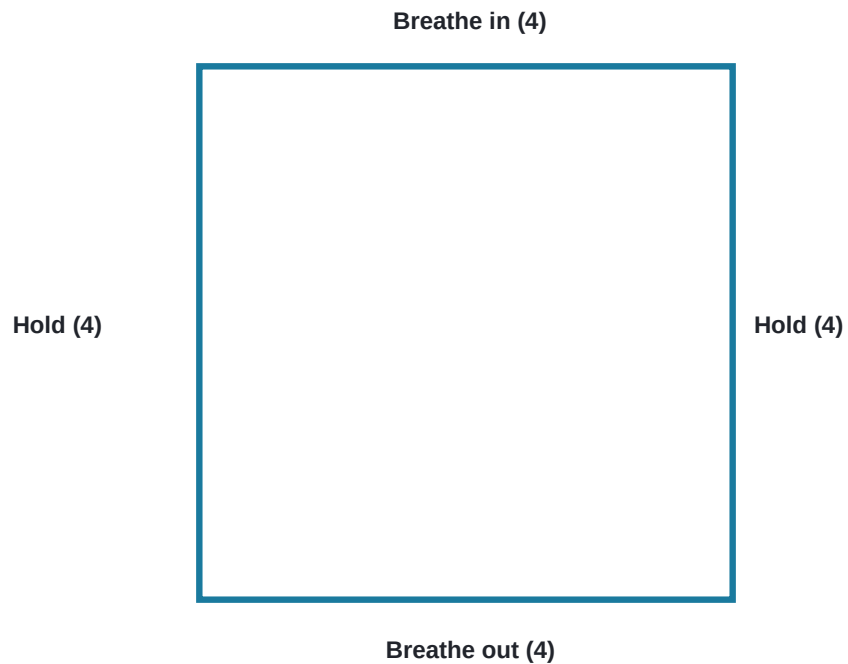
Small tools for big feelings.



# Square (Box) Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

## Box Breathing



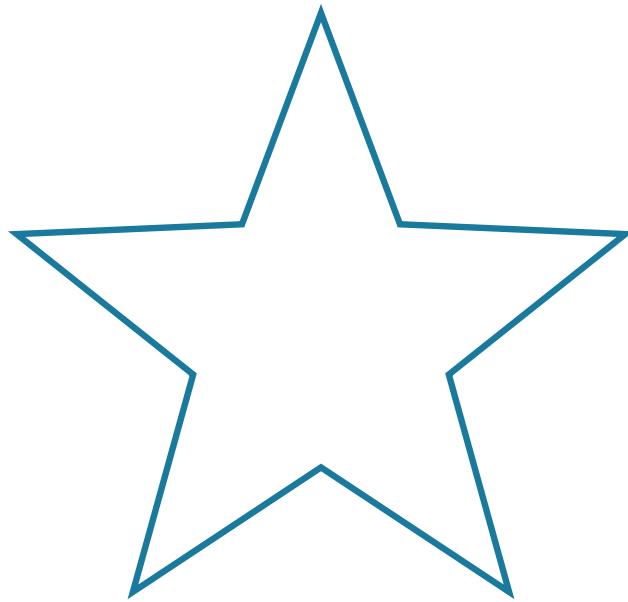
1. Trace up one side as you breathe IN for 4.
2. Trace across the top as you HOLD for 4.
3. Trace down as you breathe OUT for 4.
4. Trace across the bottom as you HOLD for 4.
5. Repeat 3-5 times until you feel calmer.



# Star Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

## Star Breathing



1. Trace up a point as you breathe IN.
2. Trace down as you breathe OUT.
3. Keep going around all five points slowly.
4. Finish with one big calm breath.

# Calm-Down Cards (Set 1)



These are calm-down tools. Try each one. Circle the ones that work best for YOU, then cut them out or copy them for your calm corner.

**1 Deep Breaths**

Slow belly breaths - in for 4, out for 6.

**2 Count to 10**

Count slowly and unclench your hands.

**3 Cold Water**

Splash your face or hold something cool.

**4 Push the Wall**

Press your hands on a wall for 10 seconds.

**5 Name 5 Things**

Name 5 things you can see right now.

**6 Ask for a Break**

Say: 'I need a minute to calm down.'

# Calm-Down Cards (Set 2)



These are calm-down tools. Try each one. Circle the ones that work best for YOU, then cut them out or copy them for your calm corner.

**1 Squeeze & Release**

Tense muscles for 5, then let go.

**2 Draw It Out**

Draw or scribble how you feel.

**3 Move Your Body**

Stretch, jump, or take a walk.

**4 Safe Person**

Talk to someone you trust.

**5 Calm Words**

Say: 'This is hard, but it will pass.'

**6 Calm Corner**

Go to your calm spot for a reset.

# Calming Words to Trace



Trace the calming words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

---

I can handle this.

---

This feeling will pass.

---

Now write your own calming words:

---

---

MATCH

# Match the Tool to the Moment



Draw a line from each moment to a tool that can help.

● Feeling angry

talk to someone ●

● Feeling worried

get a hug or rest ●

● Feeling restless

move your body ●

● Feeling sad

take slow breaths ●

# Trying Out My Tools



● A calm-down tool I want to try is...

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● When I could use it is...

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● How I hope it will help me...

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## Part 3: Solving Feeling Mysteries

Use your clues to choose calm.

# Mystery Cases (1)



Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** A classmate is quiet and won't play today. What might they feel? What could you do?

*What could you do?*

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- 2** You feel grumpy but don't know why. What clues can you check?

*What could you do?*

---

---

- 3** A friend suddenly gets angry during a game. What might be going on?

*What could you do?*

---

---



## Mystery Cases (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** You feel nervous but excited before a big event. Name both feelings.

*What could you do?*

---

---

- 2** Someone online seems upset. How can you tell, and what can you do?

*What could you do?*

---

---

- 3** You snapped at someone. What feeling was underneath it?

*What could you do?*

---

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## Part 4: Calm & Reflect

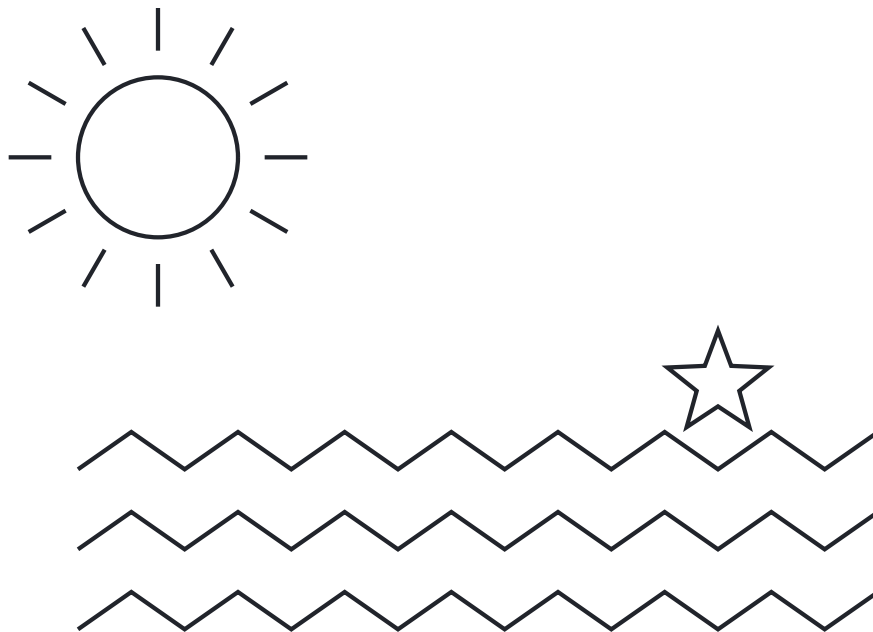
Rest your mind and notice the good.

COLOR

# Calm Beach



A quiet place by the gentle sea



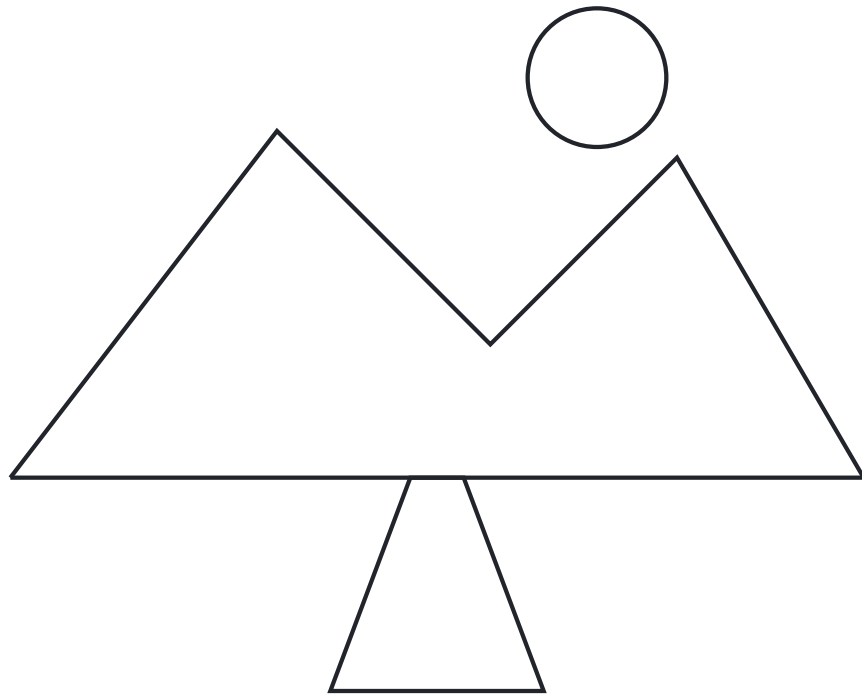
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

# Peaceful Mountains



Breathe in the fresh mountain air



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

# Cozy Corner



A safe, comfy place to rest



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

# My Calm Place



- Describe or draw a place where you feel calm.

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---

- What do you see, hear, and feel there?

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---

---

Draw your calm place:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.



## Part 5: My Practice Week

Practice makes calm feel natural.

# Monday & Tuesday



## Monday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---

## Tuesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---



# Wednesday & Thursday

## Wednesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---

## Thursday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---

# Friday & Weekend



## Friday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---

## Weekend



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

---

# My Practice Week Review



● Which calm-down tool did I use the most?

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● Which tool worked best for me?

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● What do I want to keep practicing next week?

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# My Top Calm-Down Tools

Out of everything you tried, which tools help YOU most? Write your personal top tools so you remember them when a big feeling shows up.

1

2

3

4

5

When I feel calm, I can help others by...



## How Far I've Come

Look how much you've learned! Tick everything you can do now (or are practicing).

- ☐ I can name my feelings.
- ☐ I can notice feelings in my body.
- ☐ I know my warning signs for big feelings.
- ☐ I have calm-down tools I can use.
- ☐ I can make calmer choices.
- ☐ I can ask for help when I need it.
- ☐ I can be kind to myself when things are hard.



# My Personal Calm-Down Plan

This is YOUR plan for big feelings. Fill it in and keep it somewhere you'll see it. You can update it any time as you learn what helps.

**When I notice a big feeling, my body signal is...**

---

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**Three calm-down tools I will try first are...**

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**A safe person I can talk to is...**

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---

**Words I can say to myself are...**

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**A calm place I can go is...**

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# Good Things & Gratitude

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

## Three good things about today

---

---

---

## Someone I'm thankful for - and why

---

---

## Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.



# Letter to Myself

- Write a kind letter to yourself for a day you feel a big feeling.

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---

---

- What do you want to remember?

---

---

---

- What would you tell a friend feeling the same way?

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# My Growing Skills



● One feeling I understand better now is...

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---

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● One thing I can do when it gets big is...

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● I feel proud that I can...

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# Slowing Down My Mind



● When my mind feels busy, I can...

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● A quiet thing I enjoy is...

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● One slow, calm thing I will do today is...

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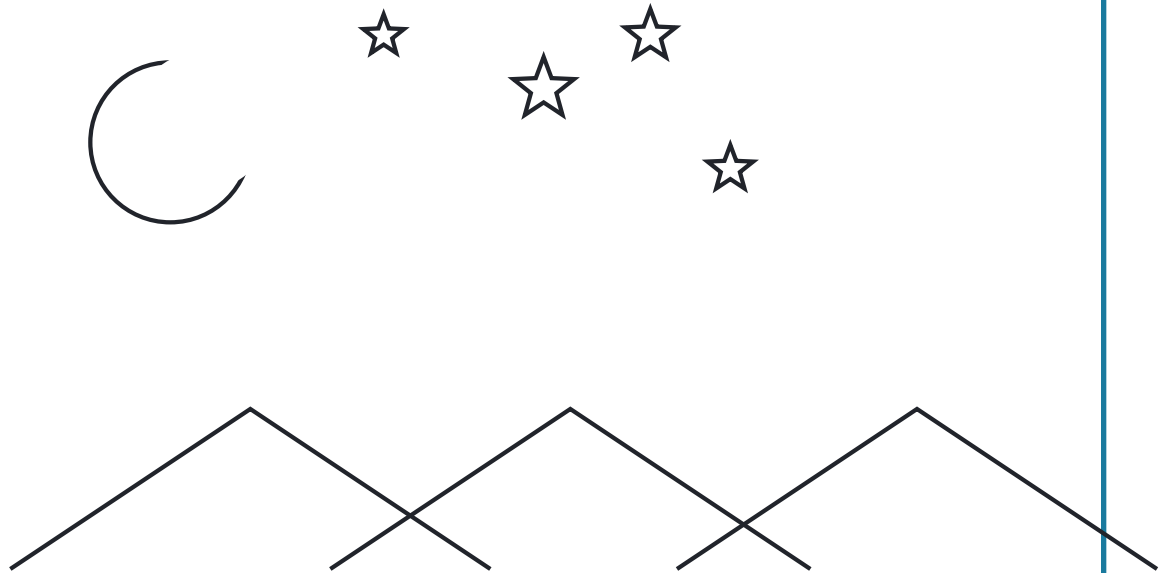
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COLOR

# Starry Night



A peaceful, starry sky to unwind under

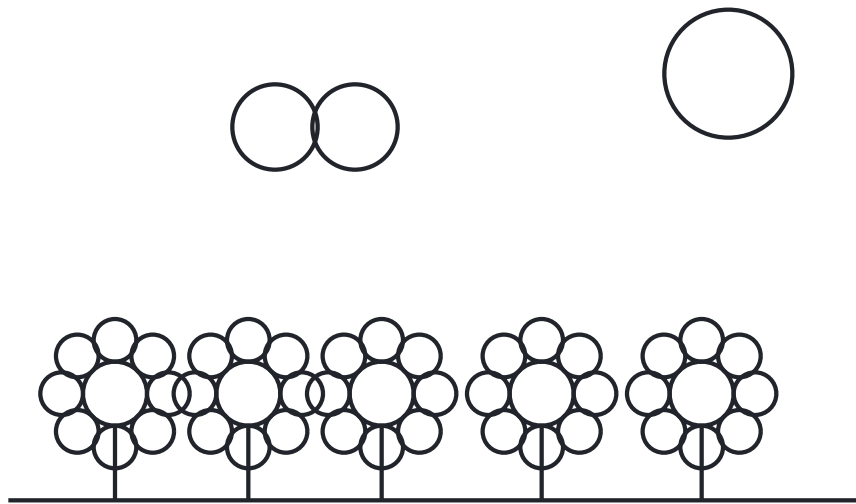


Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

# Flower Garden



A calm garden bursting with flowers



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

# Cozy Corner



A safe, comfy place to rest



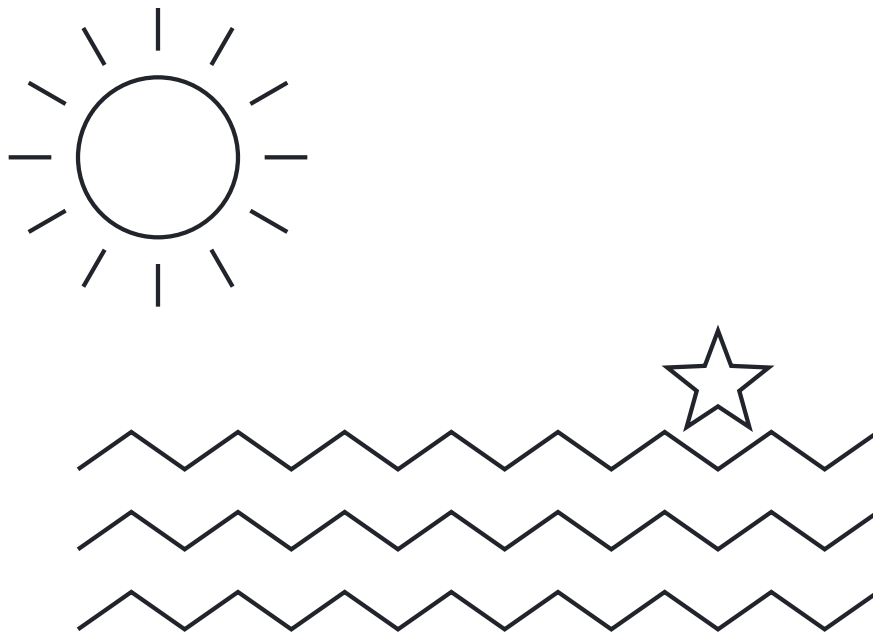
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

# Calm Beach



Gentle waves on a quiet shore



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

# My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page.

# My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page below the header.